Stream Dex Case Study

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Community manager and live-ops systems designer. I build games that live inside a Twitch chat.

Stream Dex is a Pokémon collection game played entirely in Twitch chat: catching, evolution, eggs, a Buddy system, trading and an economy with its own shop. I designed it, built every part of it alone, and have run it live on my channel six nights a week since March 2025 `LAUNCH MONTH TO CONFIRM`, through three major versions and three regions.

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`Placeholder A1`

60 to 90 second video

A wild Pokémon appears, chat throws balls, someone evolves live with sound, a trade goes through, the Pokédex page opens. Captions, no narration.

+84%	697,000+	7,800+	500+
Hours watched, year on year	**Commands run by players**	**Pokémon caught**	**Broadcasts**
SullyGnome, 12 months to 2 Nov 2026 vs the prior 12	Stream Dex player data, 68 trainers, Feb to Oct 2026	7,866 catches from 19,147 balls thrown, same data	TwitchTracker, 2 Nov 2026: 511 active days of 747

01 The problem

A three-hour nightly stream on a small channel has three enemies. Lurkers who watch but never chat. Viewers who leave at the ad break and do not come back. Followers who visit once and never return.

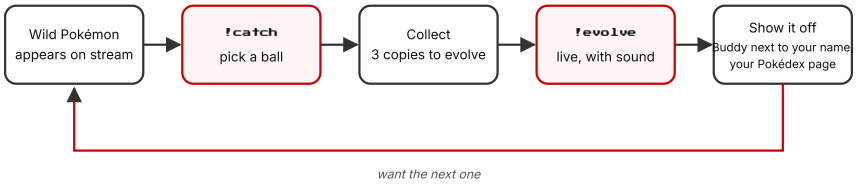
Chat games existed, but none of them rewarded the four behaviours my channel needed in one coherent loop: staying, chatting, returning and subscribing. Most were a single command with a random result and no progression, so they were fun for a week and then ignored.

The constraints were just as clear. No budget, no game engine, one person. It had to run live six nights a week without ever breaking the stream, and a new viewer had to be able to start playing from chat with no explanation.

02 The design

Everything in Stream Dex hangs off one loop. A wild Pokémon appears on the stream overlay, you throw a ball from chat, you collect copies, you evolve them live with sound and animation, and you show the result off: your Buddy walks next to your name in chat and your Pokédex page fills up. Then you want the next one.

Core loop



Progression layers

Each layer adds one more reason to return. None of them is required to play; all of them reward presence.

LAYER	MECHANIC	BEHAVIOUR IT REWARDS
Collection	Wild spawns at random while I stream. One throw per spawn. Tiered balls: Poké (free, never runs out), Great, Ultra, Master (guaranteed).	Being present when a spawn happens.
Evolution	Three copies evolve one Pokémon (Magikarp and Swablu need 20, Feebas 10, Nincada 9). Some lines also need a stone, a 2,500-point friendship bond, or a trade. Wurmple and Clamperl evolve at random.	Long-term collecting, planning, social play.
Buddy	Equip any Pokémon you own. It appears beside your chat name and friendship grows while you watch. `!buddy greet` banks it, `!buddy pet` adds 10 with a Pet Token, `!buddy feed` adds 250 with a Berry. Friendship is shared across the evolution line.	Watch time, chat identity, small daily rituals.
Eggs	One Egg at a time. It hatches after 20 hours in the stream, and the time only counts while you are there. Baby Pokémon never appear in the wild.	Return visits across many streams.
Trading	Player-to-player offers in chat with a one-minute window to answer and a repeat to confirm. Trade evolutions fire automatically when both sides end up with three or more.	Viewer-to-viewer relationships.
Pokédex site	A personal page per player: regions, type mastery, catch performance, Trainer Journey, Buddy, bag and shop. `!pokedex` rebuilds it and posts the link in chat.	Pride, completion drive, a shareable link.

Economy: faucets and sinks

Pokecoins are the only currency. Every number below is live today and documented in the Trainer's Handbook.

Faucets (coins in)

- Coins trickle in while you watch. Subscribers earn a little extra.
- Every catch pays. A Legendary catch pays everyone in chat.
- Every ad break pays everyone 150 coins, then a 90-second `!bonus` window opens: 100 unsubscribed, 350 Tier 1, 600 Tier 2, 850 Tier 3.
- Release spare fully evolved Pokémon for coins, up to 10,000 for a Legendary. Stone evolutions pay extra. You always keep one copy.
- Predictions, challenges and giveaways on stream.

Sinks (coins out)

POKéMART ITEM	PRICE	BAG CAP
Great Ball	250	99
Ultra Ball	1,000	99
Berry	1,000	3
Evolution stone (6 kinds)	2,500	3 each
Egg	2,500	1
Master Ball	60,000	10

All sales final. Nothing can be sold back.

Guardrails

- Bag caps on every item, so hoarding cannot break the economy.
- You never pay for something you cannot carry: a full bag means nothing is charged.
- Mythic Pokémon (Mew, Celebi, Jirachi, Deoxys) cannot be traded or released and never spawn in the wild.
- One throw per spawn, one trade at a time, one Egg at a time, one bonus claim per ad break.
- An evolution waits until the encounter on screen has finished.

Social broadcast moments

- A Master Ball purchase is announced to the whole stream, on purpose.
- A Legendary catch pays everyone in chat, so one player's luck becomes a shared moment.
- Evolutions and hatches play on the overlay with sound, so the room reacts.

Retention hooks mapped to Twitch's real problems

TWITCH PROBLEM	WHAT STREAM DEX DOES ABOUT IT
Ad-break drop-off	150 coins to everyone who is still there when the ad ends, then a 90-second bonus window. Leaving at the ad break costs you twice.
Lurkers	Coins and Buddy friendship accrue silently while you watch, so lurking is still progress. The first catch is one word in chat.
Followers who never return	Eggs and friendship only advance while you are present. A 20-hour Egg is six or seven streams.
Monetisation	Subscribers earn more per hour and the ad-break bonus scales by tier (100, 350, 600, 850). Gifted subs, bits and predictions all feed back into the game.

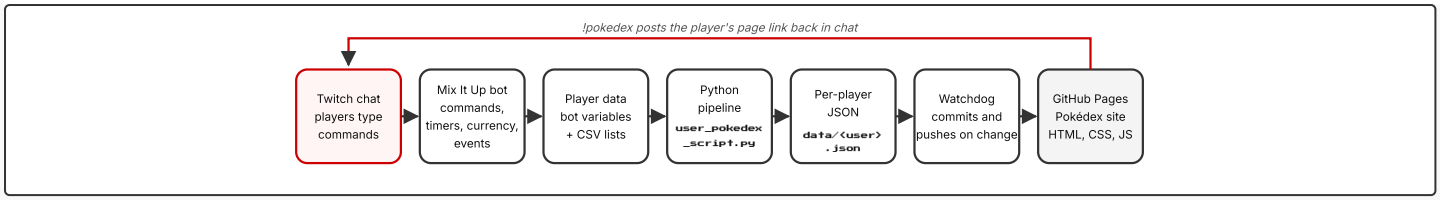
The game as players see it

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Six screenshots pending: wild spawn overlay, evolution animation, Buddy in chat, a Pokédex page, the shop list, the Handbook.

03 The build

There is no game engine. The bot does the game logic, a Python script turns each player's data into a JSON file, and a static website on GitHub Pages renders it. A watchdog pushes the data after every change, so a player's page is live a few seconds after they type `!pokedex`.



Stack, stated honestly

- **Mix It Up** (stream bot, no-code logic): every command, timer, currency rule, overlay event and sound.
- **Python**: the pipeline that reads the bot's variables and the Pokémon list, computes stats, evolution requirements and type matchups, and writes one JSON file per player. A second script watches the data folder and commits and pushes on every change.
- **HTML, CSS, JavaScript, JSON**: the Pokédex site, fully client-side, on **GitHub Pages**.
- **AI-assisted coding**: I used AI tools while writing the Python and the website code. The design, the rules, the numbers and every decision about what to build are mine.

I am the only person who has worked on it. The public repository holds 896 commits as of 2 November 2026: about 800 of them are the watchdog pushing player data after streams, and 93 are my own changes to the site.

Version history DATES AND CHANGE LISTS TO CONFIRM

V1

March 2025 (to confirm)

- Kanto region (151 Pokémon).
- Catching with tiered balls, evolution by copies, the Pokémart.
- Change list to be supplied.

V2

Date to confirm

- Johto region (100 more Pokémon).
- Buddy system, Eggs, trading (to confirm which arrived here).
- Change list to be supplied.

V3

Date to confirm

- Hoenn region (135 more Pokémon), release-for-coins sink, ad-break bonus (to confirm).
- Pokédex website: first commit 7 Feb 2026, landing page 19 Feb 2026 (from the repository history).
- Shop tab and Trainer's Handbook: 17 Oct 2026 (from the repository history).

Documentation

The Trainer's Handbook puts every command, rule, price and rate in one place, with a five-step quick start at the top. New players onboard themselves from chat, and the moderators point to one page instead of answering the same question twice.

04 The results

Channel level

Public data, 12 months to 2 November 2026 compared with the 12 months before.

20,066	430	15	1,257
Hours watched	Followers gained	Average viewers	Hours streamed
+84.4%	+51.9%	+25%	+42.7%, 278 streams

Source: SullyGnome 365-day summary, read 2 Nov 2026.

Before and after launch DATA PENDING

Monthly average viewers, chat messages and unique chatters, September 2024 to September 2025, with the launch month marked. The chart reads from `data/case-study-metrics.json` and renders itself once the numbers are in.

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Twitch Channel Analytics export

Three small charts appear here, one per metric, as soon as the monthly numbers are filled into `data/case-study-metrics.json`. The export is broadcaster-only: Creator Dashboard, Analytics, Channel Analytics, date range 1 Sept 2024 to today, Export CSV.

Player level

The system's own data: the per-player JSON files in the public repository, recomputed on 2 November 2026. Each file is rebuilt when that player runs `!pokedex`, so every figure is as of the player's last refresh, between 27 February and 31 October 2026. 68 trainers have a valid file.

697,632	448,692	19,147	7,866	8,648	1,141	132	240
Commands run	Chat messages	Balls thrown	Pokémon caught	Pokémon held	Evolutions	Trade records	Eggs hatched

The same 68 players account for 13,233 hours watched and 5,806 stream visits. Pokémon held is higher than Pokémon caught because hatches, trades and event rewards add to a collection while evolutions consume copies.

Community

788 followers. 53 active subscribers on about 20 average viewers, 34 of them gifted. 21,472 bits lifetime. TwitchTracker ranks the channel in the top 1.17% of Twitch channels.

Source: Twitch About panel and TwitchTracker overview, read 2 Nov 2026.

What players say QUOTES PENDING

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Three to five viewer or moderator quotes pending, with permission to use the handles.

> Channel growth has several causes: the schedule, the games I pick, collaborations and raids. Stream Dex is the largest single change in the period, and the player data above shows how much of the activity in chat runs through it.

05 What I learned DRAFT

Placeholder A7, draft

This section will be two or three short paragraphs in my own words. These are the questions it answers, specific and unglamorous:

1. What broke the economy the first time, and how I fixed it.
2. Why the bag caps exist.
   Draft note: 99 Great Balls, 99 Ultra Balls, 10 Master Balls, 3 Berries, 3 of each stone, 1 Egg, so that nobody can stockpile their way out of the sinks.
3. What the ad-break payout and the 90-second bonus window did to the viewer count during ads.
4. How I decided the evolution costs.
   Draft note: three copies as the default, twenty for Magikarp and Swablu, a 2,500-point friendship bond that is spent on each evolution, and trade-only lines so that some progress needs another person.
5. What I would cut if I started over.

06 Beyond the game

Community operations. I wrote the chat rules and enforce them, run a moderator team and AutoMod, and keep the community together across Discord, YouTube (a main channel and a VOD channel), TikTok and Instagram.

Partnerships. Three independent musicians soundtrack the stream in a cross-promotion deal: their music plays live and their work is promoted on stream. NAMES PENDING CONSENT (A6)

Before streaming. At HOG Esports in Yangon (2018 to 2021) I led sponsorship acquisition tied to six-figure partnership agreements and produced national tournaments: the WESG South-East Asia Myanmar qualifiers (2018, 2019), MPL Myanmar seasons 1 and 2, the Synnex Myanmar Game Show 2019 and the Road to Razer SEA Invitational 2020. TO CONFIRM

07 Contact

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Stream Dex: scromf9001.github.io/dexforge
Trainer's Handbook: scromf9001.github.io/dexforge/tutorial

Stream Dex is a fan-made, non-commercial project. Pokémon is © Nintendo, Game Freak and The Pokémon Company. Every mechanic described here transfers to an original creature set.